

Nathaniel Posner

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EDUCATION

Columbia Business School

PhD Candidate in Marketing; Consumer Behavior

New York, NY

Expected May 2027

MPhil, Marketing

May 2025

Vassar College

BA, Major: Psychology

Minor: Economics

Poughkeepsie, NY

May 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Psychology of money and debt, social cognition, choice architecture, prosocial behavior

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Posner, N., Simonov, A., Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E. J. (2023). [Dark Defaults: Choice Architecture Steers Political Campaign Donations](#). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 120(40), e2218385120.

- Winner of 2024 AMA-EBSCO-RRBM award for Responsible Research in Marketing.
- Covered in NPR's [The Indicator from Planet Money](#) and [Morning Edition](#).

Reeck, C., **Posner, N.**, Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E. J. (2023). [Nudging App Adoption: Choice Architecture Facilitates Consumer Uptake of Mobile Apps](#). *Journal of Marketing* 87(4), 510-527.

Mrkva, K., **Posner, N.**, Reeck, C., & Johnson, E. J. (2021). [Do Nudges Reduce Disparities? Choice Architecture Compensates for Low Consumer Knowledge](#). *Journal of Marketing* 85(4), 67-84.

- Finalist for the 2023 AMA-EBSCO-RRBM award for Responsible Research in Marketing.
- Honorable Mention for the 2022 BSPA Best Paper Award

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Reeck, C., **Posner, N.**, Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E.J. (2025). [Bringing digital designs to light](#). *California Management Review*.

Mrkva, K., Johnson, E. J., Reeck, C., & **Posner, N.** (2021). [Design systems with your most vulnerable users in mind](#). *Harvard Business Review*.

WORKING PAPERS AND IN THE REVIEW PROCESS

Posner, N., Davidai, S., & Morwitz, V. Misperceptions of Indebtedness Promote Prosociality. *Revise and resubmit at Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*.

Posner, N., Park, E., & Schmitt, B. [Variability, Mind Perception, and Trust in Artificial Intelligence](#). *Revise and resubmit at the Journal of Marketing*.

Posner, N., & Gladstone, J. Principal Linearity Neglect. *Revise and resubmit at the Journal of Consumer Psychology*.

Posner, N., & Morwitz, V. When do we Ask? A Norms-Based Account of Consumer Informal Borrowing. *Under review at the Journal of Consumer Research*.

Posner, N., Friedman, E., & Dana, J. Personal Boycotts.

Posner, N. & Morwitz, V. Market-Social Choices.

SELECTED RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Posner, N. & Morwitz, V. Imposition Versus Impoliteness in Requests for Time and Money.

Posner, N., Krefeld-Schwalb, A., & Van den Bergh, B. How People Spend “Free” Money.

Posner, N., & Gladstone, J. The Relationship Between Optimism and Debt.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (*presenter)

Posner, N.*, Krefeld-Schwalb, A., & Van den Bergh, B. (October 2025). The Impact of Rewards on Past and Future Effort. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Talk presented as part of a special session.

Posner, N.*, & Morwitz, V. (October 2025). When do we Ask? A Norms-Based Account of Consumer Informal Borrowing. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Talk presented as part of a special session.

Posner, N.*, & Morwitz, V. (May 2025). Psychological Interest Rates. *Colorado Conference on Consumer Financial Decision Making*. Poster.

Posner, N., Park, E. S.*, & Schmitt, B. (March 2025). When Consumers Credit AI with Consciousness. *Society for Consumer Psychology Conference (SCP)*. Competitive paper.

Posner, N.*, Krefeld-Schwalb, A., & Van den Bergh, B. (November 2024). Psychological Impacts of Receiving “Free” Money. *Society for Judgment and Decision-Making Conference (SJDM)*. Poster.

Posner, N.*, & Davidai, S. (September 2024). Misperceptions of Indebtedness Promote Prosociality. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Competitive paper.

Posner, N.*, Park, E. S., & Schmitt, B. (September 2024). When Consumers Credit AI with Consciousness. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Talk presented as part of a special session.

Posner, N.*, Simonov, A., Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E. J. (August 2024). Dark Defaults: How Choice Architecture Steers Political Campaign Donations. *American Marketing Association Conference (AMA)*. Invited talk.

Posner, N.*, & Davidai, S. (March 2024). Who Pays the Bill? Misperceptions of Indebtedness in Joint Consumption. *Society for Consumer Psychology Conference (SCP)*. Competitive paper.

Posner, N.*, & Morwitz, V. (October 2023). From Friends to Firms: Dissecting Consumer Reactions to Time and Money Requests Across Diverse Relationships. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Poster.

Posner, N.*, Simonov, A., Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E. J. (October 2022). Dark

Defaults: How Choice Architecture Steers Campaign Donations. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Talk presented as part of a special session.

Reeck, C.*, **Posner, N.**, Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E. J. (October 2021). Nudging app adoption: Choice architecture increases adoption of COVID-19 digital contact tracing. *Association for Consumer Research Conference (ACR)*. Virtual.

Reeck, C.*, **Posner, N.**, Mrkva, K., & Johnson, E.J. (2021). Choice Architecture Facilitates Adoption of COVID-19 Digital Contact Tracing. *Conference on Behavioral Economics Experiments and Insights on COVID-19*. Virtual.

Mrkva, K. *, **Posner, N.**, Reeck, C., & Johnson, E. J. (December 2020). Do Nudges Reduce Disparities? Choice Architecture Compensates for Low Knowledge and SES. *Society for Judgment and Decision-Making Conference (SJDM)*. Virtual.

RESEARCH SUPPORT AND OTHER GRANTS

Psychological Interest Rates. Bernstein Center Leadership Grant, 2025.

Columbia Business School Doctoral Fellowship, 2025.

Psychological Interest Rates. Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Dissertation Grant, 2024.

Psychological Interest Rates. Luxury Education Foundation Award, 2024.

Psychological Interest Rates. Columbia Business School Marketing Department Research Grant, 2024.

Dark Defaults: How Choice Architecture Steers Political Campaign Donations. AMA-EBSCO-RRBM Responsible Research in Marketing Grant, 2024.

Psychological Interest Rates. Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Seed Grant, 2024.

Poverty and Self-efficacy. Vassar College Undergraduate Research Award, 2018.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

European Journal of Social Psychology 2025, ad hoc reviewer.
Journal of Consumer Research 2025, trainee reviewer.
Society for Consumer Psychology Conference 2024, 2025, 2026, ad hoc reviewer.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Hortense Fong, Malek Ben Sliman, MBA Marketing Analytics. Fall 2025
Eric Johnson, MBA Behavioral Economics and Decision Making, Spring 2025
Michel Pham, PhD Experimental Design, Spring 2024
Shawndra Hill, MBA Data Science for Marketing Managers, Spring 2024
Andrey Simonov, Undergraduate Marketing Management, Fall 2023, MBA Core Marketing, Fall 2024, 2025
Ran Kivetz, MBA Core Marketing, Fall 2023
Ran Kivetz, EMBA Marketing Strategy, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023
Ran Kivetz, EMBA High-Tech Entrepreneurship, Spring 2023, Spring 2024
Eric Johnson and Stephen Zeldes, MBA Psychology and Economics of Consumer Finance, Spring 2022.

HONORS AND AWARDS

AMA-Sheth Doctoral Consortium Fellow (2026)
Luxury Education Foundation Award (2024)
AMA-EBSCO-RRBM Award for Responsible Research in Marketing (2024)
Phi Beta Kappa (2019)
Psi Chi (2018)